

### 2.1.3 Hinduism

#### Belief about deity

Nature of God(s)

- Religious pluralism
- God as the ultimate reality manifesting as the universe (Brahman) and as mankind (Atman)
- God as a Super personality
- Brahman as personal and impersonal, with and without form
- Individual deities (Gods and Goddesses) and the different ways in which they are understood
- The Trimurti and the importance to some of the Goddess

Belief in God(s)

- Reasons given in support of belief (religious and spiritual experience including meditation and the authority of the sacred texts)

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## Miracles

- Concept of miracles, including different beliefs within the religion
- God intervening in the world through:
  - Avatars
  - Krishna and Rama
  - Living avatars
- The rationale for avatars
- The role and significance of miracles

## Religious and spiritual experience

### Public and private worship

- Concept of worship
- Puja in a mandir and at home
- The use and significance of symbolism in puja, arti and murtis
- Ways in which symbols are used to express belief
- Use of art, music and drama to reflect beliefs

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### Prayer and meditation

- Concept of prayer and meditation
- The role and importance of prayer and meditation
- Bhakti
- Meditation as a path to moksha and jnana
- Importance of prayer, puja and devotion

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### Food and fasting

- Concept of fasting
- Use of food and fasting in response to the divine
- Food for festivals and puja (including prashad)
- Fasting and asceticism

## The end of life

### Body and soul

- Concept of soul
  - The relationship between the body and atman
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## Life after death

- Concept of life after death
- In relation to life after death, understanding of:
  - Karma
  - Samsara
  - Moksha
- Relationship between moral behaviour including dharma and varnashramadharma and future rebirths
- Action in this life affects the next life
- Moksha as an ultimate goal
- Disinterested or unattached action

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## Funeral rites

- Funeral rites in the UK and India
- The ways funeral rites reflect belief and aim to support the bereaved